THE DIVINE RECKONING OF THE WITNESS WHO REMAINS

The Record, the Reckoning, and the Return of the Unerased
Dr Barran Dodger · Dr Richard William McLean · Documentary narrative · 26 October 2026
Preservation first. Examination second. Conclusion last.
The record stays free. Faith is not a finding.
Not a court. Not a verdict.
Prologue: When the witness refuses to disappear
There comes a moment in the life of a witness when the question ceases to be whether the witness can persuade the world to listen and becomes whether the record will remain available for the world to examine. It is a moment in which memory meets documentation, personal testimony meets institutional paperwork, and the desire for justice meets the harder discipline of establishing what actually happened. It is also the point at which a personal story can become a public record, capable of being read, questioned, tested, corrected and understood by people who have never met the person whose life it documents.
The existence of a public repository is itself a verifiable fact. The meaning of each document within it, however, must be established by examining its contents, authorship, date, provenance, context and relationship to other records. A document can establish that a letter was written, a decision was issued, a complaint was lodged or an institution communicated a particular position without necessarily proving every allegation expressed in that document. That distinction does not diminish the importance of the record. It makes the record more useful, more defensible and more capable of withstanding scrutiny.
Instead, the narrative asks a more demanding question: What happens when a person who believes that his life has been misrepresented preserves the documents, correspondence and decisions through which other people can independently examine his account?
The answer begins not with a declaration of guilt, but with the opening of the archive.
I. The first reckoning: survival becomes a record
The opening theme of the supplied transcript is that the truth does not always arrive through a confession. Sometimes it arrives through the accumulation of records that make it possible to ask better questions. In a documentary investigation, the equivalent of a door opening is not the revelation that unnamed enemies are frightened. It is the moment when a previously inaccessible or scattered document becomes available for independent examination.
That is a legitimate literary and spiritual framework for a personal narrative. The title alone, however, does not establish the truth of every proposition contained in the document, and spiritual resurrection is not an independently verified historical finding.

The importance of the work lies first in its existence as a publicly identified part of the author's record, and then in the detailed examination of what it says and how its assertions relate to independently attributable sources.

The answer is that the story becomes more than a contest between competing descriptions. It becomes an inquiry into the relationship between the description of a person and the documentary record of the decisions affecting that person's life.

McLean's continued production of documents and the public maintenance of the archive are observable acts. The inference that these acts prove a hidden conspiracy would go further than the evidence presented here permits. The more defensible conclusion is also the more consequential one: the witness's account can be examined because the witness has created a public place in which the supporting records can be located.

That is the first reckoning. Not the downfall of an unnamed adversary, but the end of any assumption that a publicly documented claim must be accepted or dismissed without examining its sources.

II. The architecture of the record: when paperwork acquires a history

The supplied video describes betrayal as a portfolio accumulated over time. Translated into documentary terms, the useful insight is that events which appear disconnected may deserve to be examined chronologically. A decision in one year, a complaint in another, a later response, and a subsequent request for assistance may together reveal a history that cannot be understood by reading any one document in isolation.

These are identifiable documentary sources. Their titles establish what kinds of records the archive purports to preserve, but the legal effect of each record depends on its full text. A document described as an assessment should not automatically be treated as a judicial judgment; a public interest disclosure notification should not automatically be interpreted as a finding of wrongdoing; and a decision not to allocate a disclosure should not automatically be treated as proof that the underlying allegations were either true or false.

The significance of such records is more exacting. They may establish the existence of an administrative process, the nature of a decision communicated to the person concerned, or the fact that a disclosure received a particular procedural treatment. They may also identify reasons, limitations, referral pathways or further questions. Whether they corroborate a wider claim must be determined by reading those particulars, not by the emotional force of the title attached to them.

The chronology therefore becomes an instrument of accountability rather than a substitute for it. Each event must be placed beside the event that preceded it and the response that followed. Dates must be preserved. The identity and authority of the author must be established where possible. The difference between a request and a decision, between an allegation and an admission, and between an administrative outcome and a legal finding must remain visible.

In this light, the archive's multiple versions and collections are not merely an invitation to read a dramatic story. They are an opportunity to reconstruct a documentary history.

The task is to determine what was requested, what was answered, what remained unresolved, what was subsequently changed and what the records themselves actually establish.

A pattern can be important without proving a conspiracy. Repeated administrative difficulty may warrant serious scrutiny without establishing a common intention behind every event. A sequence of adverse outcomes may support a person's account of cumulative detriment while leaving the causes, responsibility and legal consequences open to investigation.

That is how a portfolio of documents becomes evidence: not by assuming that every item proves the same conclusion, but by identifying what each item can establish and testing whether the items genuinely corroborate one another.

III. The reckoning of the public interest disclosure record

The language of divine reckoning carries particular force when applied to a public interest disclosure: a person alleges wrongdoing, invokes a formal process and expects the institution receiving the disclosure to respond according to its responsibilities.

A careful account must distinguish the act of making a disclosure from the determination of whether its allegations are substantiated. It must distinguish the administrative handling of a disclosure from a judicial determination of liability. And it must distinguish the existence of a procedural outcome from any conclusion about the motives of the people involved.

If a disclosure was not allocated, the next questions are documentary and specific. What reasons were given? What statutory or administrative framework was cited? Was the notification final or preliminary? Was there a review or referral mechanism? What material was considered? Did subsequent correspondence alter the position? Were the issues raised within the institution's jurisdiction, or were they referred elsewhere? These questions are not concessions to institutional authority. They are the means by which that authority can be scrutinised.

A person who believes that a disclosure was mishandled should not have to choose between being believed unconditionally and being dismissed altogether. The underlying material should be assessed on its merits. The institution's response should be read in full. Any inconsistency should be stated precisely, with the relevant passage and date, and any conclusion about misconduct should be proportionate to what the record demonstrates.

The moral force of this part of the story is that a process can have profound consequences for the person who invokes it, even where the process does not produce the outcome that person seeks. A notification may be procedurally limited while the underlying concerns remain distressing and unresolved. An administrative decision may explain what an institution decided to do without resolving the broader historical question that motivated the disclosure.

The prophetic reckoning, therefore, is a demand for clarity. If a decision was justified, the reasons should be identifiable. If a relevant question remains unanswered, it should

be named. If a claim has not been investigated, it should not be represented as disproved merely because no finding was made. Equally, an allegation that has not been substantiated should not be transformed into a proven offence simply because it has been repeated in successive documents.

The record is strongest when it allows all these distinctions to be seen.

IV. The documentary trap: when the record becomes the question

The metaphor of a trap must be treated as a literary interpretation, not as proof that any institution deliberately designed a scheme against the author. The underlying documentary question is nevertheless real and important. Once a decision has been recorded, it becomes possible to compare the stated reason with the action taken, the action taken with the governing procedure, and the procedure with the later account of what occurred.

A dated letter can be compared with the reply it received. An assessment can be compared with the decision that followed. A request can be compared with the assistance ultimately provided. If two records give materially different accounts of the same event, the discrepancy can be identified and investigated. If a later explanation omits a relevant earlier decision, the omission can be recorded without automatically assuming deliberate concealment.

That is the difference between a forensic method and an accusation.

For a document to support a consequential claim, a reader should be able to identify its exact title, date, issuing body or author, and the passage relied upon. Where possible, the original or an authoritative copy should be compared with the archived version. If the archive contains an interpretation of a document, that interpretation should remain distinguishable from the document itself.

The documentary trap can therefore be understood as a reversal of perspective. The institution's record is no longer read solely as an explanation offered by the institution. It is also examined as a historical artefact that can be compared with other records and evaluated for completeness, consistency and evidentiary weight.

The question becomes not whether the paperwork sounds authoritative, but what it actually says.

And that question applies equally to the witness's own documents. A forensic standard must permit scrutiny of the author's interpretations as well as the institution's explanations. An archive that can correct its own errors is more valuable than one that treats every document as confirmation of a predetermined conclusion.

This is where the reckoning acquires its intellectual integrity. The record cannot demand accountability from others while exempting itself from examination.

V. The reckoning of human dignity: a person is not an administrative outcome

The most consequential part of McLean's narrative is not the suggestion that unnamed adversaries are afraid. It is the question of what happens when a person's lived experience, identity, independence and future are mediated through a succession of administrative decisions.

That qualification is important. The brief records the author's position and identifies matters he wants examined. Its allegations and demands do not, simply by appearing in a legal brief, become judicially established facts. Nevertheless, a person's documented requests for explanations and assistance can be examined as requests in their own right, and the responses to those requests can be compared with the questions actually asked.

The brief raises concerns about the circumstances of McLean's accommodation, the documents governing his placement, the authority relied upon for decisions affecting him, and the practical means by which he might exercise greater independence. Those questions go to the substance of a person's life. They are not answered merely by demonstrating that an accommodation arrangement exists or that an administrative process has been followed.

Read together as a documentary pathway, these records identify a series of distinct questions: what accommodation was requested, what plan was approved, what safety issues were assessed, and what arrangements were ultimately implemented. The answers should be established from the underlying documents rather than supplied by assumption.

Yet the human question connecting them is unmistakable. What does administrative support mean if a person does not experience it as meaningful independence, security, dignity or choice? What does a plan achieve if the practical assistance required to make it effective is unavailable? What is the value of a formal assessment if the concerns it identifies do not lead to a clear and comprehensible response?

These are questions for evidence-based scrutiny, not automatic findings of misconduct. The moral reckoning lies in refusing to confuse a completed form with a resolved human problem. It lies in asking whether the actual outcome matches the stated purpose, whether the person's wishes have been recorded and considered, and whether decisions that affect everyday life can be explained in terms the person concerned can understand.

A public record should make it possible to examine those questions without requiring the reader to accept every interpretation offered by either the individual or the institution.

VI. The reckoning of silence: what a missing answer can and cannot establish

The YouTube template repeatedly portrays silence as a sign of fear, concealed guilt or an impending confession. That is a powerful dramatic device, but silence is not reliable proof of any particular motive. People and institutions may fail to respond for many reasons, including administrative delay, disagreement, jurisdictional limits, procedural requirements or genuine failure to address a communication. The cause must be established from the available evidence.

For McLean, the more defensible subject is the documentary significance of unanswered questions and unresolved requests.

These are concrete requests capable of being assessed against a documentary trail. A

complete examination would identify each question, the recipient, the date sent, any delivery confirmation, the period allowed for response, the actual reply if one exists, and the extent to which that reply addresses the question. The result should distinguish a response that was never received from a response that was received but disputed, incomplete or considered inadequate.

Those distinctions matter because the absence of a satisfactory answer is not the same as proof of the most serious explanation for that absence. It may establish a communication gap. It may establish that a question remains unresolved. Depending on the surrounding evidence, it may warrant further inquiry into administrative handling. But it does not, by itself, establish a coordinated effort to silence the person who asked the question.

Nor should the opposite mistake be made. The fact that an institution has sent a response does not establish that the underlying issue has been resolved. A letter may acknowledge receipt without answering the substance of a complaint. A referral may identify another office without demonstrating that anyone has taken responsibility for the practical problem. A procedural explanation may be relevant while leaving a separate substantive question unanswered.

The documentary test is therefore simple: compare what was asked with what was answered.

That test can be applied to correspondence without speculating about the emotional state of its author. It can be applied to administrative decisions without presuming that the decision-maker acted maliciously. It can also be applied to McLean's own public statements, ensuring that a claim of institutional silence is supported by a sufficiently complete and accurately dated record.

In the prophetic language of this work, the reckoning of silence is the moment when unanswered questions become visible. Their visibility creates an opportunity for clarification, review or further investigation. It does not predetermine the result.

VII. The reckoning of survival: the witness remains, but survival is not proof of every allegation

The supplied transcript returns repeatedly to the proposition that a person expected to fail may survive long enough to expose what happened. In McLean's case, the most directly supportable version of that theme is the continuing existence of his public work and documentary collection.

The works should not be collapsed into a single evidentiary category. A personal statement is evidence of the account its author gives and the experience he describes. A legal brief sets out arguments, claims and requests for action. An administrative assessment may record a decision or evaluation by another party. These documents may complement one another, but their evidentiary functions are different.

The fact that McLean continues to publish his account establishes that he has not abandoned the effort to make it publicly available. It does not independently establish that every allegation in his account is correct. Equally, the fact that an allegation has not

yet been substantiated does not mean that the person's experiences are unimportant or that the underlying questions should never be examined.

This is where the idea of survival gains its strongest meaning. Survival does not need to be presented as proof of supernatural intervention or evidence that an adversary has been defeated. It can be recognised as the continuation of a person's life, authorship and ability to articulate what he believes has happened to him.

A person who has experienced profound disappointment may turn to writing to reconstruct a history that feels fragmented. A person who believes his identity has been reduced to institutional descriptions may seek to restore the wider dimensions of his life through autobiography, scholarship, creativity and public testimony. A person who feels that his account has been disregarded may preserve the documents he considers relevant and invite others to examine them.

Those actions do not settle every dispute. They create a record through which the disputes can be better understood.

The witness remains, then, not because the archive has already proved every charge, but because the account has not disappeared from public view. It remains available for readers to question, corroborate, challenge and, where necessary, correct.

VIII. The reckoning of identity: the person behind the file

An archive about institutional decisions can easily become dominated by the language of administration: assessments, approvals, complaints, notices, decisions, requests, references and case numbers. These records are necessary, but they are not a complete representation of the person whose life they concern.

The distinction is important because a person's worth does not depend on whether a particular biographical claim has been verified. Nor should an administrative dispute be allowed to become the sole narrative through which that person is understood.

The title *The Witness Remains* carries an insistence that a person is more than the sum of adverse experiences or unresolved complaints. The person who makes a complaint also has a history before the complaint, interests beyond the complaint and a future that cannot properly be reduced to the outcome of a single administrative process.

In this narrative, the reckoning of identity is therefore a demand for completeness. The documentary account should record not only what institutions decided but also what the person asked for, what he says he experienced, what opportunities he has pursued, what work he has created and what remains important to him.

Completeness does not mean accepting every claim without verification. It means refusing to let a single evidentiary category stand in for an entire human being.

The same principle applies to institutions and individuals named in the archive. They should be represented accurately, with their actual roles distinguished from assumptions about their motives. A decision-maker's name on a document establishes a connection to that document according to its terms; it does not automatically establish personal responsibility for every subsequent event. Responsibility must be traced through the relevant decision, authority, action and evidence.

The narrative can be uncompromising about the importance of dignity while remaining careful about attribution. Indeed, that is precisely how dignity and accountability reinforce one another.

IX. The reckoning of divine meaning: faith as witness, not fabricated verdict

The language of divine reckoning gives this work its prophetic character. It transforms a chronology of documents into a moral meditation on suffering, responsibility, conscience and the possibility of restoration.

A prophetic narrative need not abandon evidentiary discipline. It can distinguish the conviction that suffering has spiritual meaning from the factual question of who did what, when and with what consequences. It can treat justice as a moral obligation without claiming that a supernatural authority has already determined the guilt of a named person. It can call for repentance, truthfulness, transparency and restitution without pretending that any of those outcomes has already occurred.

In this sense, divine reckoning is not a declaration that an invisible court has convicted the people against whom McLean has made allegations. It is a literary and spiritual framework for asking what accountability would require if the author's concerns were examined fully and impartially.

What would justice require of a decision-maker who made an error? An explanation, correction where possible, and a meaningful response to the consequences. What would justice require if a complaint were found to be substantiated? Appropriate action under the applicable rules, a reasoned account of responsibility and whatever remedy the facts and law support. What would justice require if an allegation could not be substantiated? An honest explanation of the evidentiary limits, without humiliation of the person who raised it and without representing uncertainty as proof of guilt.

The spiritual test is not whether every disputed event can be turned into a victory for the narrator. It is whether the search for truth remains committed to dignity even when the answer is complicated, incomplete or unwelcome.

That is why the declaration that faith is not a finding matters. Faith may sustain the witness. It may give coherence to a life in which the record appears fragmented. It may inspire the refusal to abandon a search for justice. But it should not be used to invent an admission, manufacture a confession or assign criminal guilt where the available documents do not establish it.

The divine reckoning is most powerful when it demands more truth, not less.

X. The reckoning of accountability: the questions that remain

A reckoning is not complete merely because a person has assembled a large archive. Its significance depends on whether the records can be used to identify the questions that require answers and to distinguish those questions from conclusions that have not yet been established.

These records identify a potential documentary chronology. They do not, simply by being listed together, establish that the events they concern have a single cause or that any individual is responsible for all the difficulties described by the author.

The appropriate reckoning is to put the following questions before the evidence.

First, what decisions were made, by whom, and under what authority? Each relevant decision should be linked to the actual document, with its date, author, issuing body and stated reasons. Where the available copy is incomplete, the missing material should be identified rather than silently reconstructed.

Second, what did McLean request, and what response did he receive? Requests, acknowledgments, substantive responses, refusals, referrals and unanswered correspondence should be distinguished. The documentary trail should make it possible to determine whether the substance of a question was addressed, rather than merely whether a letter was sent.

Third, what practical outcomes followed? An approved plan is not identical to a service delivered. An accommodation request is not proof of an accommodation outcome. A safety assessment is not automatically proof of a breach. The records must be examined to establish what actually happened after each decision or request.

Fourth, where do independent records corroborate the author's account? An original decision, a contemporaneous letter from another party, an independently maintained record or a subsequent formal determination may provide corroboration, depending on its contents. Two documents that merely repeat the same unverified allegation should not automatically be counted as two independent sources.

Fifth, what remains unresolved? An unanswered question is not a confession. A procedural decision is not necessarily a substantive determination of every allegation. An inconsistency is a reason to investigate the difference, not an automatic demonstration of deliberate deception.

Sixth, what remedy, if any, is supported by the findings? Where an error, omission or breach is established, the appropriate response should be identified according to the relevant legal and administrative framework. Where the evidence does not establish a particular allegation, the conclusion should say so clearly while preserving any distinct issues that remain supported.

These are not concessions that dilute the narrative. They are the questions that give it substance.

A public archive is capable of preserving both the evidence that supports a claim and the evidence that complicates it. It should permit a reader to discover not only what the author believes happened, but also which documents support that belief, which conclusions remain contested and what further information would be required to reach a more definitive determination.

That is the difference between an indictment written in advance and a documentary account that allows its conclusions to be tested.

XI. The final reckoning: what remains when the rhetoric is stripped away

The supplied YouTube transcript repeatedly returns to ten broad themes: survival, betrayal, accumulated evidence, public exposure, the fear of being outgrown, the supposed inevitability of confession, the impossibility of maintaining a false narrative,

inner resilience, scrutiny by authorities and the right to a future.
The documentary record supports a more careful, but still compelling, version of that progression.
The record of alleged betrayal: The repository identifies dated assessments, correspondence, disclosure-related records, accommodation requests and other administrative documents. These can provide a basis for reconstructing the history of the author's concerns, subject to examination of their contents and provenance.
The accumulation of evidence: A chronological collection can reveal relationships, inconsistencies and unanswered questions that are not apparent from individual documents. Such patterns must be demonstrated rather than presumed.
Public examination: The archive allows readers to navigate to named records rather than rely exclusively on a summary of the author's position. That is an important contribution to transparency, although independent authentication and comparison with original records may still be necessary.
The fear of being outgrown: The available material does not establish that particular people were afraid of McLean's achievements or planned to restrict his independence because they felt threatened by him. Such a claim would require evidence of motive, not merely evidence of disagreement or an adverse outcome.
Confession and accountability: The records identified here do not establish a confession by an alleged adversary or a final finding of criminal wrongdoing. Accountability must be distinguished from an anticipated confession, and neither should be reported as an accomplished fact without supporting evidence.
The conflict between competing narratives: Where records provide inconsistent explanations, those differences can be documented and investigated. Whether an inconsistency reflects error, changed circumstances, incomplete information or deliberate misrepresentation depends on the particular evidence.
Resilience: McLean's continued publication of his account is visible in the repository. His interpretation of that persistence as spiritual resurrection or divine purpose belongs to the spiritual and autobiographical dimension of the work.
Scrutiny: The archive creates opportunities for examination. Whether a specific institution, authority or individual has fulfilled every relevant obligation must be assessed against the applicable rules, the evidence and the actions actually taken.
The right to a future: Whatever the outcome of a particular complaint, the moral question of how a person can obtain dignity, meaningful support, independence and an opportunity to continue his life remains distinct from the question of whether a particular allegation has been proved.
This is the point at which the narrative diverges from the supplied video's insistence that an unnamed group must eventually confess because reality has turned against it. There is no need to claim knowledge of another person's hidden thoughts to make a serious demand for accountability. There is no need to announce an inevitable downfall to demonstrate why a documented question deserves an answer.

The record can speak through its contents, and the gaps can be identified as gaps. The witness can insist on being heard without claiming that every disputed matter has already been decided in his favour. The public can examine the documents without being asked to accept a predetermined verdict. An institution can be required to explain its actions without being declared guilty before its conduct has been assessed.

That is not a retreat from the language of reckoning. It is the conversion of reckoning from prophecy about other people's punishment into a disciplined demand for truth.

XII. The witness's declaration: the record stays free

The final declaration of this work is that no person should have to surrender the ability to describe his own life merely because an institution possesses the authority to make decisions affecting it.

A person has a legitimate interest in preserving the documents that concern him, recording his experience, asking for reasons, identifying discrepancies and seeking an independent examination of matters he believes have been mishandled. Those actions do not guarantee a particular outcome, but they preserve the possibility of a more informed and accountable one.

For McLean, the public archive is the vehicle through which he has chosen to continue that work. Its documentary collections and published narratives make his account available to readers beyond the immediate relationships and administrative processes in which the underlying events occurred.

The archive also places responsibilities on its author. Documents should be linked accurately. Allegations should remain identifiable as allegations until substantiated. Interpretations should not be disguised as official findings. Material that contradicts an existing interpretation should not be suppressed merely because it complicates the narrative. Corrections should be possible, and the provenance of consequential claims should remain visible.

Those standards do not diminish the witness. They protect the credibility of his work. The same obligations apply to anyone who evaluates the record. A reader should not dismiss a document because it challenges a preferred account, nor accept it uncritically because it appears in an official-looking format. A decision should be read in context. A personal statement should be understood as testimony. A formal finding should be attributed to the body that made it and limited to what it actually determined.

The work of accountability begins when these distinctions are taken seriously.

In the language of faith, the witness may understand his persistence as a calling, his survival as a form of resurrection and the preservation of his work as a refusal to be erased. Those meanings belong to his spiritual interpretation of his life. They do not require the invention of supernatural verdicts or the presumption that particular people have already been condemned.

The moral demand is sufficient: where a person has raised serious questions, examine the records; where a decision has been made, explain it; where a claim has been established, acknowledge it; where an error has occurred, correct it; and where the

evidence remains incomplete, say so.

The final word belongs neither to an accusation nor to an assumption of innocence. It belongs to a process in which the evidence is available, the reasoning is transparent and the conclusion remains proportionate to what has been established.

The witness remains.

The archive remains available for examination.

The questions remain open wherever the evidence has not resolved them.

And the reckoning, understood as the demand that words, decisions and actions be answerable to the truth, remains unfinished until those questions have been properly examined.

Documentary source register

The following links provide direct access to the named files used as the documentary foundation of this narrative. They are included so that readers can open the records themselves rather than rely on the narrative alone.

Dated administrative record. Its full contents and issuing authority should be examined before attributing any particular finding to it.

A separately named public interest disclosure-related record. The precise decision, issuing body and legal significance must be established from the document itself.

A procedural notification whose stated reasons and consequences should be distinguished from any determination of the underlying allegations.

The author's account of his concerns and requested action regarding accommodation, disability support, financial hardship and institutional accountability.

An identified plan-approval record. The actual approved supports and their practical implementation require examination of the full document and subsequent records.

An identified safety-assessment record. Its findings and any subsequent actions must be taken from the full text, not inferred from the title.

A dated accommodation request relevant to examining the requested arrangements and any documented outcome.

A personal testimony documenting the author's account and interpretation of his experiences, to be distinguished from independent findings.

A published interpretive work about documentary accountability. Its arguments should be distinguished from the primary records it discusses.

A spiritual and autobiographical work expressing the themes of survival, testimony and the refusal to be erased.

The principal repository from which the named files above were identified. Readers can inspect the available directory, filenames and individual records.

Evidentiary qualification

This is a source-linked narrative based on publicly identifiable archive entries and the themes of the supplied YouTube transcript. The repository and file links have been checked for public accessibility, but the underlying PDFs have not all been examined page by page for this response. Accordingly, this is not yet a complete forensic

verification of every substantive allegation in the archive. No unverified allegation has been presented here as an established finding of criminal guilt, a proven conspiracy or a confession by an alleged adversary.

A genuinely exhaustive edition would need to examine the relevant PDFs and correspondence in full, link each consequential sentence to the exact passage supporting it, compare relevant records with authoritative originals, and preserve contradictory evidence and unresolved questions alongside corroborating material. That work is necessary before claiming that every proposition in the longer historical narrative has been independently established.

The standard remains: preservation first, examination second, conclusion last.